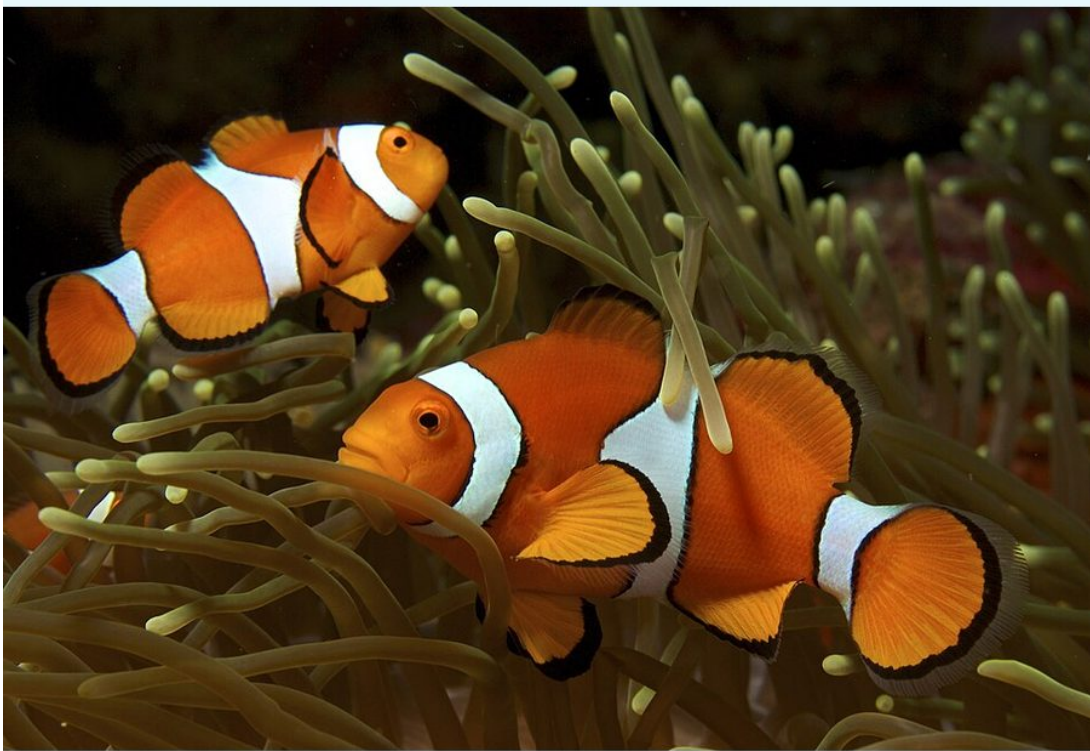


Reef Keeper

Livestock Field Guide

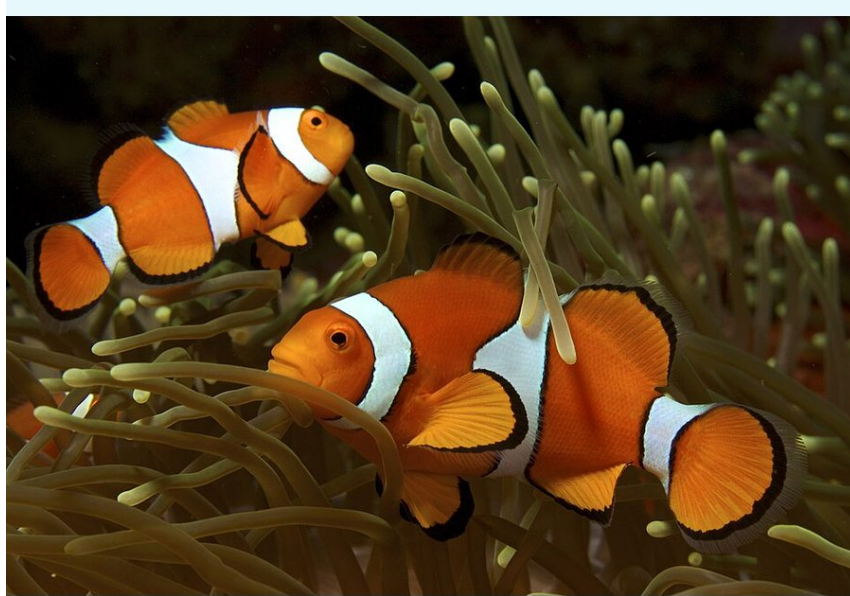
A printable coffee-table guide to the fish, corals, anemones, and invertebrates in your reef tank.



Prepared for your 120-gallon mixed reef system.

Clownfish pair

Amphiprion ocellaris (verify exact species)



Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific reefs; your pair hosts the Duncan coral and regularly lays eggs.

- Territorial pair-bonding damselfish; spawning is a sign of comfort and routine.
- Can host anemones, but also often adopts corals such as Duncan, hammer, or leather corals.
- Watch the hosted coral for irritation if the pair becomes too rough.

Your tank: Your tank note: breeding pair; currently using the Duncan as their host.

Yellow coris / canary wrasse

Halichoeres chrysus



Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific reef flats and lagoons.

- Sand-sleeping wrasse; needs a sand bed for normal resting behavior.
- Active forager that may pick at small pests and benthic invertebrates.
- Needs a tight lid because wrasses are strong jumpers.

Your tank: Your tank note: active wrasse community member.

Melanurus wrasse

Halichoeres melanurus



Natural range / location: Western Pacific and Indo-Pacific reef habitats.

- Useful active hunter in mixed reef systems.
- Sleeps in sand and may dive when startled.
- Can outcompete slower feeders, so observe feeding balance.

Your tank: Your tank note: one of the tank's established wrasses.

Red Head Solon Fairy Wrasse

Cirrhilabrus solorensis (taxonomy/photos may appear as *C. aquamarinus*)



Natural range / location: Western Pacific reef slopes and rubble zones.

- Fairy wrasses are open-water planktivores rather than sand-sleeping Halichoeres wrasses.
- Color and display behavior are often best with low stress and good nutrition.
- A tight lid is essential; fairy wrasses jump.

Your tank: Your tank note: blue body, pink/red head, black mark under chin.

Banggai cardinalfish

Pterapogon kauderni



Natural range / location: Banggai Archipelago, Indonesia; a geographically restricted species.

- Slow, hovering cardinalfish that appreciates calmer areas.
- Mouthbrooding species with striking vertical bars and long fins.
- Does best when not bullied by aggressive feeders.

Your tank: Your tank note: peaceful midwater fish.

Blue-green chromis

Chromis viridis (verify exact species)



Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific reefs, often associated with branching corals.

- Planktivorous damselfish; generally active in the water column.
- Can be peaceful, but groups may thin over time in aquariums.
- Benefits from frequent small feedings and good oxygenation.

Your tank: Your tank note: one blue chromis/blue-green chromis present.

Yellow tang

Zebrasoma flavescens



Natural range / location: Central Pacific, especially Hawaii and nearby reef systems.

- Constant grazer; provide algae films, nori, and open swimming room.
- Can become territorial toward similar-shaped tangs.
- A good long-term indicator of feeding and oxygenation.

Your tank: Your tank note: part of the tang group; watch feeding dominance.

White-tail bristletooth tang

Ctenochaetus flavicauda



Natural range / location: Central Pacific reef environments.

- Bristletooth tangs rasp film algae and detritus from rock surfaces.
- Generally more focused on surfaces than open algae sheets alone.
- Needs oxygenation, swimming room, and stable water quality.

Your tank: Your tank note: useful film/detritus grazer.

Desjardini sailfin tang

Zebrasoma desjardinii



Natural range / location: Indian Ocean and Red Sea reef habitats.

- Large, bold Zebrasoma tang that can outgrow smaller systems.
- Heavy grazer; contributes substantially to nutrient input through feeding.
- Needs long-term swimming room and careful tang aggression management.

Your tank: Your tank note: large grazer; account for feeding and bioload.

Orange-banded / Randall's prawn goby

Amblyeleotris randalli



Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific sand and rubble areas, often living with pistol shrimp.

- Shrimp-goby relationship: goby watches while the shrimp maintains the burrow.
- Needs sand/rubble zones and stable rockwork.
- Can be shy; target feeding may help if food does not reach the burrow.

Your tank: Your tank note: paired with a pistol shrimp.

Pistol shrimp partner

Alpheus spp. (exact species unconfirmed)



Natural range / location: Tropical reef sand/rubble burrows; exact origin depends on species.

- Maintains the shared burrow with the goby.
- The “pistol” snap can be heard when it closes its claw rapidly.
- Requires stable rockwork so burrowing does not undermine structures.

Your tank: Your tank note: paired with the orange-banded goby; add your own photo if possible.

Bubble-tip anemone

Entacmaea quadricolor



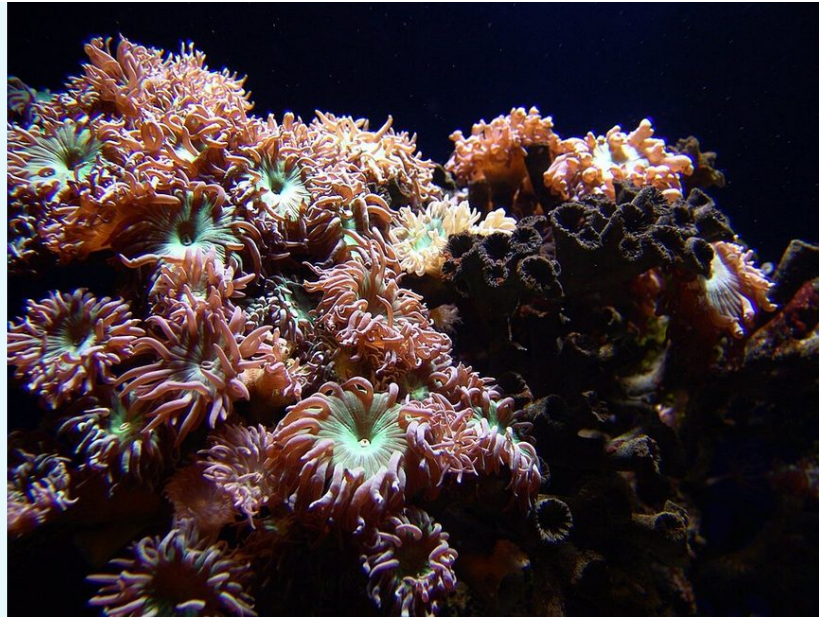
Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific reef habitats.

- Can move or split when stressed or growing.
- Powerful stinging neighbor; allow space from corals and mushrooms.
- Stable light, flow, and water quality are more important than constant adjustment.

Your tank: Your tank note: two BTAs, stationary about a year; mushrooms below may be affected.

Duncan coral

Duncanopsammia axifuga



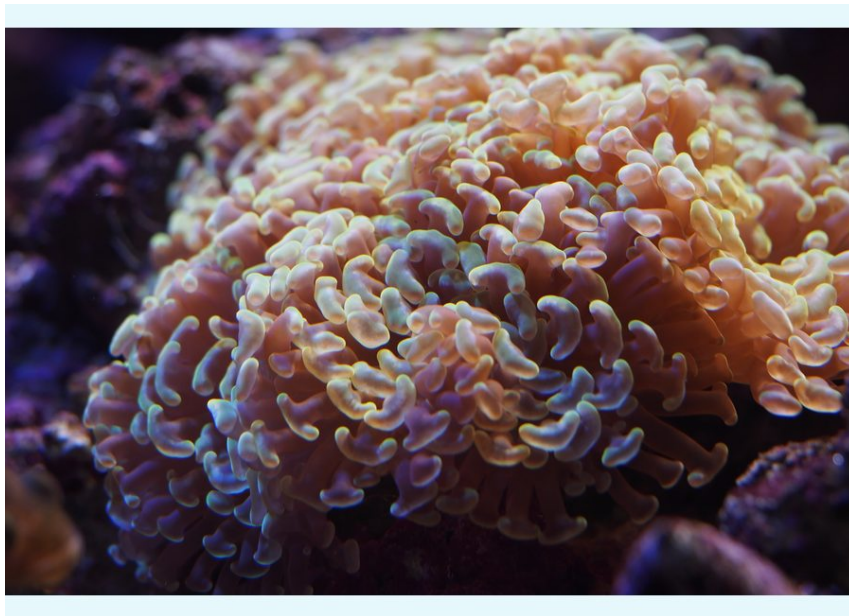
Natural range / location: Australia and nearby Indo-Pacific reef areas.

- LPS coral with fleshy polyps that often accepts meaty foods.
- Usually a forgiving coral, but still reacts to instability and irritation.
- Can be irritated if clownfish host it too aggressively.

Your tank: Your tank note: healthy and currently hosting the clownfish.

Hammer coral

Fimbriaphyllia ancora (formerly *Euphyllia ancora*)



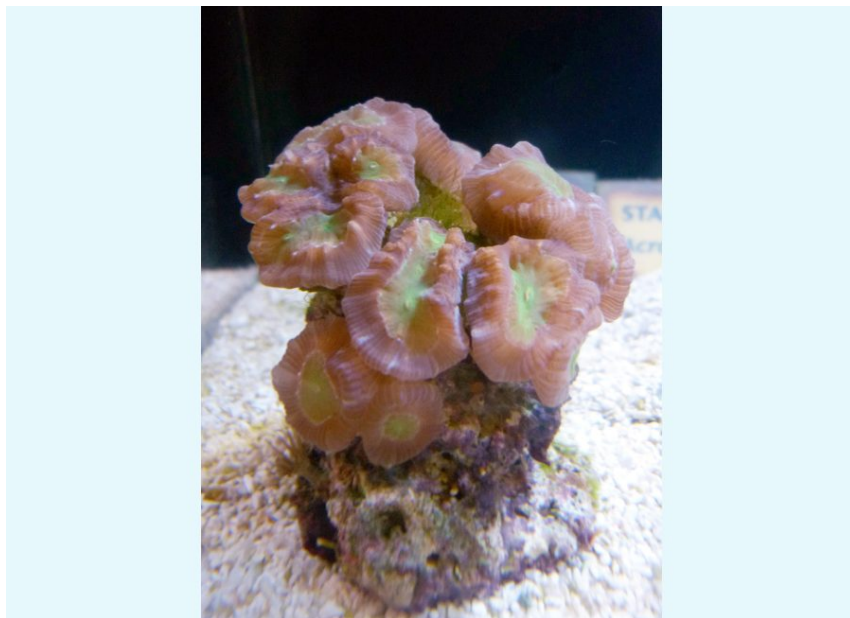
Natural range / location: Indo-West Pacific reef habitats.

- LPS coral with stinging tentacles; give space from neighbors.
- Sensitive to alkalinity swings and rapid nutrient changes.
- Moderate flow should move the polyps without blasting tissue.

Your tank: Your tank note: two surviving colonies; monitor recovery.

Green candy cane / trumpet coral

Caulastraea furcata



Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific reef systems.

- Hardy LPS that can be a useful stability indicator.
- Accepts target feeding but does not require heavy feeding.
- Watch tissue fullness and polyp extension as easy visual cues.

Your tank: Your tank note: green candy cane colony present.

Ricordea mushroom

Ricordea spp. (R. florida/R. yuma should be verified)



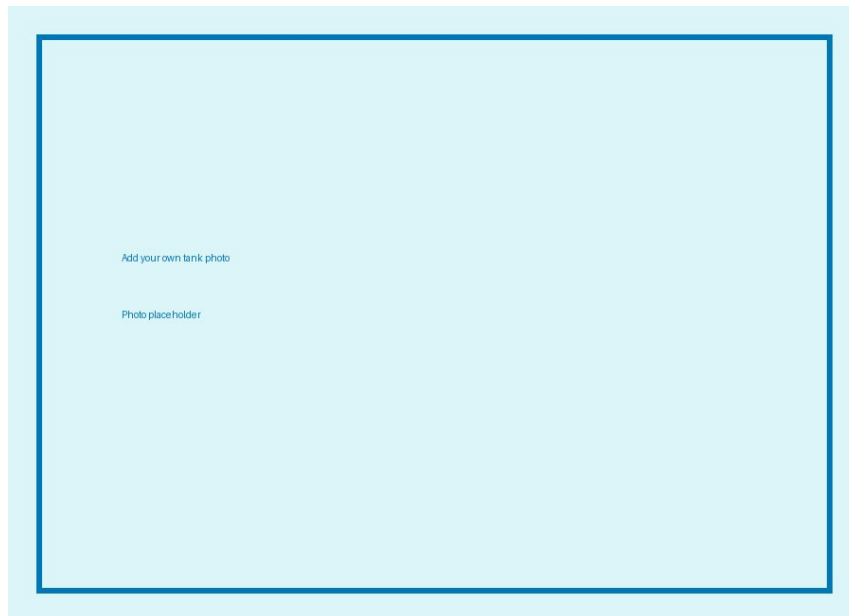
Natural range / location: Caribbean for *R. florida*; Indo-Pacific for *R. yuma*.

- Corallimorph mushroom coral; prefers lower to moderate flow.
- Can be affected by chemical warfare and nearby anemones.
- Shrinking, bleaching, or detachment are signs to reassess placement and stability.

Your tank: Your tank note: stressed below the BTAs; allelopathy/stinging is a likely concern.

Grube's gorgonian

Pinnigorgia flava



Natural range / location: Aquacultured hobby strain originally associated with the Philippines.

- Photosynthetic soft coral with thin tan to pink branches.
- Generally regarded as hardy and fast growing in reef aquaria.
- Benefits from moderate flow to keep branches clean.

Your tank: No reusable quality image found quickly; add your own tank photo later.

Halloween hermit crab

Ciliopagurus strigatus



Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific reef and rubble zones.

- Bright striped legs and strong cleanup-crew personality.
- Provide spare shells to reduce shell competition.
- May bother snails or small animals if underfed or shell-limited.

Your tank: Your tank note: two Halloween hermits present.

Sand-sifting starfish

Astropecten polyacanthus (typical ID; verify exact species)



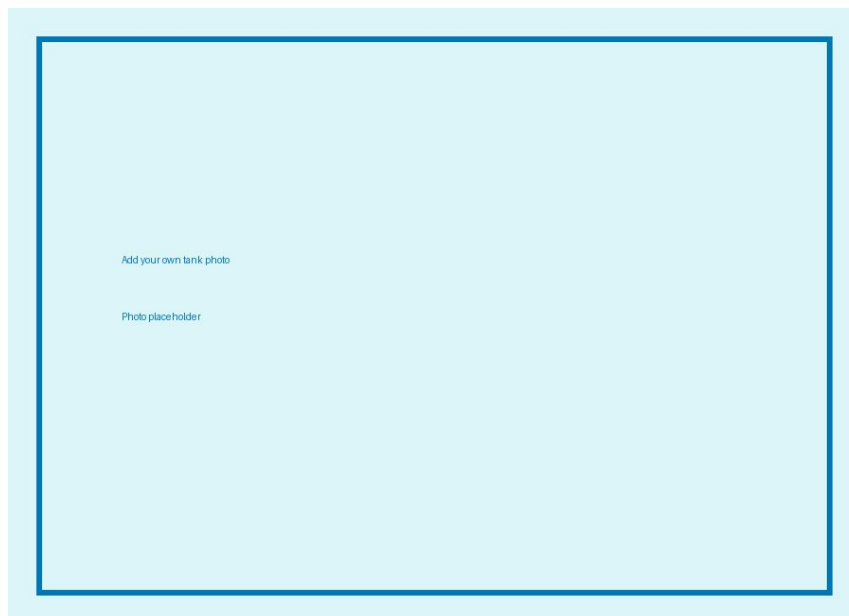
Natural range / location: Indo-Pacific sandy habitats.

- Lives in and moves through the sand bed.
- Consumes sandbed fauna and organic matter; can starve in very clean tanks.
- Monitor body fullness and activity over time.

Your tank: Your tank note: newer animal, about 1-2 months in the tank.

Serpent starfish

Ophiuroidea / Ophioderma spp. (exact species unconfirmed)



Natural range / location: Tropical reef rockwork and crevices; exact origin depends on species.

- Nocturnal scavenger that often hides under rock during the day.
- Useful cleanup animal, but exact behavior depends on species.
- Avoid overfeeding just to feed the star; use targeted small foods if needed.

Your tank: Your tank note: exact species not confirmed; add your own photo later.

Fighting conch

Strombus alatus / *Strombus* spp. (verify exact species)



Natural range / location: Sandy shallow marine habitats; Florida fighting conch is Caribbean/Florida.

- Excellent sandbed grazer and detritus processor.
- Needs open sand area and enough film/detritus to graze.
- Often visible by its eyes and trunk-like proboscis.

Your tank: Your tank note: two fighting conchs present.

Image Attribution and Notes

This booklet uses quality open-license reference images where available. Some animals in your tank have uncertain species-level IDs, so the booklet labels those as verify/exact species unconfirmed.

Clownfish: Wikimedia Commons image by Nick Hobgood; *Amphiprion ocellaris*, Papua New Guinea.

Yellow wrasse: Wikimedia Commons image by Sushi Girl1995.

Melanurus wrasse: Wikimedia Commons public-domain image, Birch Aquarium.

Red Head Solon Fairy Wrasse: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Cirrhitilabrus aquamarinus* / *solorensis* complex.

Banggai cardinalfish: Wikimedia Commons image by Peter Halasz.

Chromis: Wikimedia Commons public-domain image listed as *Chromis viridis*.

Yellow tang: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Zebrasoma flavescens*.

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Desjardini sailfin tang: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Zebrasoma desjardinii*.

Randall's prawn goby: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Amblyeleotris randalli*, Okinawa.

Bubble-tip anemone: Wikimedia Commons featured image by Nick Hobgood, *Entacmaea quadricolor*.

Duncan coral: Wikimedia Commons public-domain image listed as *Duncanopsammia axifuga*.

Hammer coral: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Euphyllia ancora*.

Candy cane coral: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Caulastrea/Caulastrea furcata*.

Ricordea: Wikimedia Commons image by Nick Hobgood, *Ricordea florida*.

Halloween hermit: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Ciliopagurus strigatus*.

Sand-sifting starfish: Wikimedia Commons image listed as *Astropecten polyacanthus*.

Fighting conch: Wikimedia Commons image by James St. John, *Strombus alatus*.

Placeholders: Use your own tank photographs for unconfirmed species and Grube's gorgonian if desired.

Practical note: For the most accurate long-term version, replace placeholder images and uncertain IDs with your own tank photographs over time.